

What the budget and the books can be connected to, and what is still missing

Following a dollar from what was budgeted to what was spent works at two levels and stops at the third. Most of what stops it is a report that has not been asked for. And there is one question we cannot settle from outside your system, which we have put to you as a question rather than a finding.

Where the dots connect today

The school department, overall

Budget against spend, whole department. This is what the review document you have is built on, and the two documents reconcile.

both sides • every year held • reconciles to \$1.93

By category code

2710 Guidance, 2305 Teachers. The district prints the code over each group and the ledger carries it in the account number, so the two can be compared category by category.

41 of 45 codes • FY2026 period 12 only

Where they stop

Below the category, at a single line

MUNIS shortens account names to ten characters, so MS GUIDANC and HS GUIDANC are both coded 2710 where the budget has a separate row for each school. Nothing in either document tells them apart.

no key from either direction

Individual transactions

We hold Account Details for the athletics revolving fund and nothing else — and even those carry no object code, so a payment cannot be attributed to a category.

fund 1301 only · 277 rows · no object code

The revolving and grant funds

We have their balances, but they are absent from the expenditure ledger, so they can sit beside the school budget and never inside it.

61 funds held · none appear in the ledger we have

State funding, at any level

Chapter 70 arrives unrestricted into the general fund. No revenue account carries a category, and no report ties aid to a particular expense.

0 of 222 revenue accounts carry a code

The asks

Four reports, in the configuration we understand them to take. Three are Tier 3 in the framing from the earlier note; the fourth is for the district rather than the Town.

1 Account Details, all school-related accounts

Account Details · all school funds, not only 300 and 301 · **with the object code**

This is the single most useful one. It opens transactions at both the department and category levels, and MUNIS already runs it — it produced the athletics files.

Worth naming the object code explicitly: the June request asked for account-level detail and what arrived was one account, CASH, with no object code on any row.

2 Expenditure detail for the school's own funds

Account type EXPENSE · Print Totals only FALSE · the grant, revolving and school choice funds

The copy we hold covers the general and enterprise funds. Running the same report for the school's funds would put them into the ledger rather than beside it.

3 Revenue report

Account type REVENUE · Print Totals only FALSE

For state and grant money coming in. This tells us how much arrived, which is worth having on its own — see the last section for what it cannot do.

4 A crosswalk, from the district

which MUNIS account each school budget line is built from

The one ask directed at the district rather than the Town, and the only thing that would open the line-item level at all. The budget is built in a workbook; whoever builds it may already know which accounts each line draws on.

Every document, itemised

FY2023 to FY2026. **37 reports from the Town Accountant** and **11 documents from the district**. Each line is one file. Spreadsheet for each; the printed copy alongside where it is no trouble, because the printout carries the options page and the spreadsheet does not.

From the Town Accountant

#	REPORT AND PARAMETERS	YEAR	WHAT IT OPENS
1	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2023 Year/Period 2023/3	Q1 position

#	REPORT AND PARAMETERS	YEAR	WHAT IT OPENS
2	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2024 Year/Period 2024/3	Q1 position
3	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2025 Year/Period 2025/3	Q1 position
4	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2026 Year/Period 2026/3	Q1 position
5	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2023 Year/Period 2023/6	Q2 position
6	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2024 Year/Period 2024/6	Q2 position
7	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2025 Year/Period 2025/6	Q2 position
8	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2026 Year/Period 2026/6	Q2 position
9	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2023 Year/Period 2023/9	Q3 position
10	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2024 Year/Period 2024/9	Q3 position
11	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2025 Year/Period 2025/9	Q3 position
12	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2026 Year/Period 2026/9	Q3 position we hold a department rollup for this one — account level is what is needed
13	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytdbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2023 Year/Period 2023/12	year-end position, books open

#	REPORT AND PARAMETERS	YEAR	WHAT IT OPENS
14	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2024 Year/Period 2024/12	year-end position, books open
15	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2025 Year/Period 2025/12	year-end position, books open
16	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2023 Year/Period 2023/13	the year as finally closed
17	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2024 Year/Period 2024/13	the year as finally closed
18	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2025 Year/Period 2025/13	the year as finally closed
19	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud Fund 0100 · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N · Suppress zero bal accts N	FY2026 Year/Period 2026/13	the year as finally closed
20	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud Fund 0100 · Account type REVENUE · Print totals only N	FY2023 Year/Period 2023/13	state aid and other revenue received
21	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud Fund 0100 · Account type REVENUE · Print totals only N	FY2024 Year/Period 2024/13	state aid and other revenue received
22	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud Fund 0100 · Account type REVENUE · Print totals only N	FY2025 Year/Period 2025/13	state aid and other revenue received
23	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud the 21 school funds listed below · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N	FY2023 Year/Period 2023/13	the funds that pay for staff and appear in no budget line
24	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud the 21 school funds listed below · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N	FY2024 Year/Period 2024/13	the funds that pay for staff and appear in no budget line
25	MUNIS Year-to-Date Budget Report glytodbud the 21 school funds listed below · Account type EXPENSE · Print totals only N	FY2025 Year/Period 2025/13	the funds that pay for staff and appear in no budget line

#	REPORT AND PARAMETERS	YEAR	WHAT IT OPENS
26	Account Details as supplied for fund 1301 in June 2026 all school-related accounts, all funds · including the object code	FY2023 full fiscal year 2023	every transaction, so a rate change can be told from a volume change
27	Account Details as supplied for fund 1301 in June 2026 all school-related accounts, all funds · including the object code	FY2024 full fiscal year 2024	every transaction, so a rate change can be told from a volume change we hold the athletics fund for this year — this is the same report for the rest
28	Account Details as supplied for fund 1301 in June 2026 all school-related accounts, all funds · including the object code	FY2025 full fiscal year 2025	every transaction, so a rate change can be told from a volume change we hold the athletics fund for this year — this is the same report for the rest
29	Account Details as supplied for fund 1301 in June 2026 all school-related accounts, all funds · including the object code	FY2026 full fiscal year 2026	every transaction, so a rate change can be told from a volume change we hold the athletics fund for this year — this is the same report for the rest
30	A report on line-item transfers name unknown to us from-account, to-account, amount, date, and the authority for each – c.44 §33B or the town meeting article	FY2023 fiscal year 2023	what authorised each budget change; the ledger shows the effect, not the counterparty
31	A report on line-item transfers name unknown to us from-account, to-account, amount, date, and the authority for each – c.44 §33B or the town meeting article	FY2024 fiscal year 2024	what authorised each budget change; the ledger shows the effect, not the counterparty
32	A report on line-item transfers name unknown to us from-account, to-account, amount, date, and the authority for each – c.44 §33B or the town meeting article	FY2025 fiscal year 2025	what authorised each budget change; the ledger shows the effect, not the counterparty
33	A report on line-item transfers name unknown to us from-account, to-account, amount, date, and the authority for each – c.44 §33B or the town meeting article	FY2026 fiscal year 2026	what authorised each budget change; the ledger shows the effect, not the counterparty
34	Purchase orders closed after the year closed not a standard report amounts and dates	FY2023 fiscal year 2023	spending that lands against a year after it closes

#	REPORT AND PARAMETERS	YEAR	WHAT IT OPENS
35	Purchase orders closed after the year closed not a standard report amounts and dates	FY2024 fiscal year 2024	spending that lands against a year after it closes
36	Purchase orders closed after the year closed not a standard report amounts and dates	FY2025 fiscal year 2025	spending that lands against a year after it closes
37	Purchase orders closed after the year closed not a standard report amounts and dates	FY2026 fiscal year 2026	spending that lands against a year after it closes

If only two are possible: the period 13 reports and Account Details. Period 12 is the position before the books close; period 13 is the year as it finally stood, and without it no year's surplus can be computed from outside at all. Account Details is the only document that shows whether a line grew because a price rose or because more was bought.

From Lunenburg Public Schools

#	DOCUMENT	YEAR	WHAT IT OPENS
D1	Proposed budget, line level the superintendent's request as presented to the School Committee	FY2024	what was asked for
D2	Proposed budget, line level the superintendent's request as presented to the School Committee	FY2025	what was asked for
D3	Proposed budget, line level the superintendent's request as presented to the School Committee	FY2026	what was asked for
D4	Approved budget, line level the budget as adopted	FY2023	what was voted
D5	Approved budget, line level the budget as adopted	FY2024	what was voted
D6	Approved budget, line level the budget as adopted	FY2025	what was voted
D7	Prior-year actuals, restated the ACTUALS column printed inside a later year's budget document	FY2024	the district's own account of the year

#	DOCUMENT	YEAR	WHAT IT OPENS
D8	Prior-year actuals, restated the ACTUALS column printed inside a later year's budget document	FY2026	the district's own account of the year
D9	Grant awards listed as listed in the district's budget documents	FY2025	what was awarded, which is not what was spent
D10	Grant awards listed as listed in the district's budget documents	FY2026	what was awarded, which is not what was spent
D11	Budget-to-account crosswalk which MUNIS account each school budget line is built from — the mapping, not the amounts	any one year	the only thing that would let a single budget line be followed into the ledger not a report; the budget is built in a workbook and whoever builds it may already hold this

The school's own funds, by number

Sixty-one funds appear in the FY2026 special revenue report. **21 had activity that year and 40 did not** — the dormant ones are closed grants holding a few hundred dollars each, and we are not asking for those. The 21 below are the request, by fund number, so nothing has to be interpreted.

#	FUND	NAME	FY26 REVENUE	FY26 SPENT	BALANCE
1	2200	School Lunch Revolving	572,231	739,586	287,771
2	1312	Extended Day Revolving Fund	192,943	233,350	54,161
3	2640	Special Ed Circuit Breaker state reimbursement for high-cost placements — offsets the placement lines directly	325,970	4,005	615,301
4	1301	Chapter 658 Revolving Fund held for FY24–FY26; listed so the set is complete	160,164	100,467	169,945
5	2813	Fy25 #240 the same grant, prior year	-0	229,398	-88,503
6	1305	After School Activities Fund	111,376	95,196	148,578
7	2814	Fy26 #240 fund code 240 is the federal special education grant, if we read the code correctly	-0	179,637	-179,637

#	FUND	NAME	FY26 REVENUE	FY26 SPENT	BALANCE
8	1308	School Choice Revolving Fund	83,116	30,558	299,461
9	2778	Fy25 117 Soa Evidence Base	-0	68,647	-91,220
10	2672	Fy26 Family & Community 237	48,558	13,372	35,186
11	1306	School Facilities Use Revolv	18,670	12,354	71,559
12	1311	School Gift Fund	22,486	2,911	109,398
13	2681	Comp School Health Serv Grant	10,775	5,120	5,655
14	1302	Adult Education Revolving Fund	4,000	2,880	12,744
15	2832	Fy25 #274 0205202509302025	-0	5,427	0
16	1300	Lost Books/Tech Rev Fund	2,860	661	16,665
17	2690	Fy26 #309 Title Iv Part A	-0	3,240	-3,240
18	2728	Fy24 Title 11 Part A #140	-0	3,217	5,108
19	2622	Fy25 Family & Community	-0	2,477	70,800
20	2800	Fy25 140 080524093026	-0	2,208	-0
21	2758	Fy23 240 the same grant, FY23	-0	1,666	-8,167

Across all sixty-one, **\$1,592,572** sits in balance. These funds pay for staff and programmes and appear in no line of the school budget document, so from outside there is no way to tell a budget line that rose because the district grew from one that rose because a grant stopped paying for part of it.

Three of these decide questions we cannot otherwise settle.

2640, Special Ed Circuit Breaker — \$325,970 received and \$615,301 held. State reimbursement for high-cost placements, which is exactly the money that offsets the placement lines where FY26 moved most.

2813 and 2814, fund code #240 — \$229,398 spent in FY25 and \$179,637 in FY26. If we read the code correctly this is the federal special education grant, and it is paying for staff who appear in no budget line. In the same year, every paraprofessional account in the district ran over budget. Those two facts may be unrelated; from outside we cannot tell, and the fund detail is what would say.

2200, School Lunch — \$739,586 spent against \$572,231 received, the largest single fund in the set.

A question for the district rather than the Town: is fund code 240 the IDEA special education grant, and are 2813 and 2814 the FY25 and FY26 awards of it? We are reading a code, not a document.

From DESE — one, and we will fetch it ourselves

All-funds per-pupil expenditure by function, FY2026, when published. Listed so the picture is complete, not as a request.

Two questions that are not documents

Is there any way to see what state aid paid for? Set out at the end of this document.

Does anything record whether a budgeted position was filled? A ledger records dollars and not people, so an unspent salary line and a vacant post are identical from outside. That distinction explains several of the largest variances in the FY26 books, and we cannot make it.

On format: the spreadsheet is the ask, and both is better

The XLSX export is what we need. The sheet gives the full coded account —

0100-3-300-**2710**-04-4-65-1-511024

— and the PDF gives a label with the code removed. That fourth segment is the *only* thing joining the district's budget to the Town's books, which is why the category comparison above works for FY2026 period 12 and no other period: that is the one report that arrived as a spreadsheet.

But the PDF alongside it is genuinely useful, so both is ideal. The printed report carries its own options page — account type, print totals only, the fund and period selected, whether revenue prints as a credit — and the spreadsheet does not. That header is how we know how a report was run, which matters as much to us as the numbers: a column of figures whose parameters we are guessing at is a column we have to hedge every time we quote it.

So: **XLSX for the data, PDF for the criteria.** If only one is possible, the spreadsheet.

Sending earlier years the same way would extend the category comparison backwards with no new report having to exist.

If any of this is not possible as described

Tell us which part, and that is more useful than the data. Everything above is our reading of what MUNIS can produce, assembled from the reports you have already sent. We are certainly wrong somewhere, and the shape of the mistake matters:

- **A parameter we have named wrongly** — then the right name saves a round trip.
- **A report that does not exist in that form** — then we would rather ask for what does.
- **A field that exists on the record but is not on the report as configured** — this is the one we would most like to hear about. The object code is the example: it is on the account, and the Account Details we received did not show it. If there are other fields sitting one checkbox away, we do not know what they are.

If it is easier to send one month, or one department, as a sample before running anything at scale, that suits us better too. A wrong field list found on one month costs a day; found on five years it costs the whole exchange.

A question we cannot answer from the outside

Is there any way to see what state aid actually paid for?

Here is what we found, and we would rather be corrected than act on it. No revenue account in anything we hold carries a category code — 0 of 222 — and the state aid accounts share no organisation code with any expense account. Reading that, we concluded that Chapter 70 arrives unrestricted into the general fund and is thereafter indistinguishable from any other revenue, so nothing records which dollar paid which bill.

If that is right, it is worth us knowing, because it is the one question on this page we would otherwise keep asking for. We would stop, and say instead what can be said: how much aid came in, what the department spent, and what the town had to raise after aid.

If it is wrong — if there is a report, a fund structure, a grant schedule or a reporting requirement that ties aid to spending, even at a category level — that would be the most valuable thing in this whole exchange, and we would not have known to ask for it.

The same question applies, more narrowly, to the grants: is there anything that records which accounts a Title grant or circuit breaker reimbursement paid into?

Every figure here was produced by querying the documents the Town and the district have published or sent, on 3 September 2026. Where this document says a report could be produced, that is our understanding of what MUNIS can do rather than a claim about your system.